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Cc: hod <hod@ee.iitkgp.ac.in>

Dear Third- and Fourth-Year Students,

I am writing to share an opportunity to participate in the **Lam Research Challenge 2026**, a nationwide systems-engineering competition being conducted in association with Lam Research, T-Works, and E-Cell, IIT Bombay.
Lam Research is one of the leading global companies developing advanced equipment used in semiconductor manufacturing. The Challenge provides students with an opportunity to work on practical engineering problems relevant to the machines and systems used in semiconductor fabrication.

Nature of the Challenge

This is not merely a software or simulation-based competition. Participating teams are expected to develop and demonstrate a **working hardware prototype** addressing a real industrial systems-engineering problem.
The project may involve the integration of areas such as:

- sensors, instrumentation, and data acquisition;
- actuators, drive electronics, and electromechanical systems;
- feedback control and industrial automation;
- embedded systems and firmware;
- robotics and mechatronics;
- mechanical design and precision mechanisms; and
- system integration, testing, reliability, and cost optimisation.

For example, tasks in an earlier edition included developing a **Peltier-based liquid-cooling system for temperature calibration** and building a **four-axis robotic arm for handling semiconductor wafers**. Such problems require students to integrate mechanical, electrical, electronics, instrumentation, control, and embedded-system knowledge rather than working within a single discipline.
The competition should therefore be particularly relevant to students interested in **instrumentation, control systems, mechatronics, robotics, embedded systems, industrial automation, power electronics, and semiconductor manufacturing equipment**.

Team-Composition Requirement

Each team must consist of **four undergraduate students** from the third or fourth year.
Importantly, **at least one member of every team must be from Mechanical Engineering**. The remaining three students may be drawn from Electrical Engineering, Instrumentation Engineering, Electronics, Computer Science, Robotics, Mechatronics, or other eligible engineering

disciplines.
Students from Electrical Engineering and Instrumentation Engineering who are interested in participating should therefore form an interdisciplinary team that includes at least one Mechanical Engineering student.

Benefits of Participation

Apart from the experience of developing a complete industrial prototype, the competition offers:

- direct interaction with engineers and technical leaders from Lam Research;
- mentorship from Lam Research engineers and other industry experts;
- possible internship and full-time employment opportunities for high-performing participants;
- cash prizes of ₹5,00,000, ₹3,00,000, and ₹1,50,000 for the top three teams; and
- sponsored travel, accommodation, meals, and local transportation for teams selected for the Grand Finale.

According to the organisers, participants from the previous two editions collectively received **30 internship offers and 9 full-time employment offers from Lam Research**. These opportunities are competitive and are not guaranteed merely through participation; nevertheless, the competition provides strong exposure to Lam Research's technical and talent teams.
IIT Kharagpur was also represented among the finalist institutions in the **2025 edition**, in which approximately 100 students participated in the concluding national round.

Registration

Registration deadline: September 3, 2026, at 11:59 PM
Registration link:

Register Here

https://lrc2026.tworks.in/team-register?utm_source=iitb&utm_medium=email
Since the registration deadline is very close, interested students are advised to form their teams and register at the earliest.
Students who are interested but require assistance in connecting with a Mechanical Engineering student may write to me. I would also be happy to provide general guidance regarding the technical scope of the competition and team formation, within the limits permitted by the competition rules.

Best Regards,
Vikrant Kumar Singh
Assistant Professor
Department of Electrical Engineering
Email Id: vikrantkumarsingh@ee.iitkgp.ac.in

IIT Kharagpur
Lab Website: https://vikrantkumarsingh-ee.github.io/pic-lab-website/

From: "shreyasdey ecell" <shreyasdey.ecell@gmail.com>
To: vikrantkumarsingh@ee.iitkgp.ac.in
Sent: Tuesday, September 1, 2026 4:11:52 PM
Subject: Request to Circulate: Lam Research Challenge 2026 | E-Cell IIT Bombay

Dear Professor Vikrant Kumar Singh,

Greetings from E-Cell, IIT Bombay.

We are writing to invite your students to participate in the **Lam Research Challenge 2026**, a systems engineering competition organised by E-Cell, IIT Bombay in partnership with Lam Research, a Fortune 500 company that manufactures equipment used in the production of nearly every advanced semiconductor chip today. Top-performing teams get a direct pathway to internship and full-time offers with Lam Research.

01 | The Challenge

Participants will develop a working prototype addressing a real industrial problem, drawing on skills across mechanical, electronics, automation, and process engineering.

02 | Prize Money (Post-Tax)

- 1st Prize: ₹5,00,000
- 1st Runner-Up: ₹3,00,000
- 2nd Runner-Up: ₹1,50,000

All finalists will also receive an official certificate from Lam Research.

03 | Career Opportunities

The top 25 teams will interact directly with Lam Research's technical and talent leadership. In previous editions, this stage has led directly to employment offers:

- 2024: 16 internship offers, 4 full-time offers
- 2025: 14 internship offers, 5 full-time offers

04 | Sponsored Travel for Finalists

Teams that reach the top 25 will have their participation in the finale fully sponsored, including:

- Return flights from their city to the venue
- Hotel accommodation for the duration of the finale
- All meals and local transportation

05 | Team Composition

- Team Size: 4 members
- Disciplines Required: One member from Mechanical (mandatory), plus three members from any discipline
- Eligibility: Students in their 3rd or 4th year of an undergraduate engineering programme

06 | Key Dates

- Registration Opens: August 2026
- Registration Closes: September 3, 2026 (11:59 PM)
- Stage 1, Qualifier Round (Online): September 2026
- Stage 2, Hardware Hustle: October 2026
- Grand Finale: First week of November 2026

07 | Request

We would be grateful if you could circulate this opportunity among students in your department/institution, so more teams can take part. Registrations close on September 3, 2026, by

11:59 PM — we encourage students to form their team of four and register at the earliest to secure their place.

Register Here

https://lrc2026.tworks.in/team-register?utm_source=iitb&utm_medium=email

For more queries: competitions@tworks.in | +91 8977942384
Pranit: +91 7600765339
Shreyas: +91 9870818508

Thank you for your support in helping us reach more talented students.
Regards,
E-Cell, IIT Bombay